The difference is that in the large metros, the number of scams may be lower, but the value per scam is higher. Someone may initially be phished and subsequently lose anywhere from ₹10 lakh to crores of rupees.

On the other hand, Bharat may have a larger number of fraud victims, but the value of individual frauds may be lower.

We are conducting a study to understand where these frauds are occurring geographically, the nature of the frauds and, where fraud has been reported, the value involved.

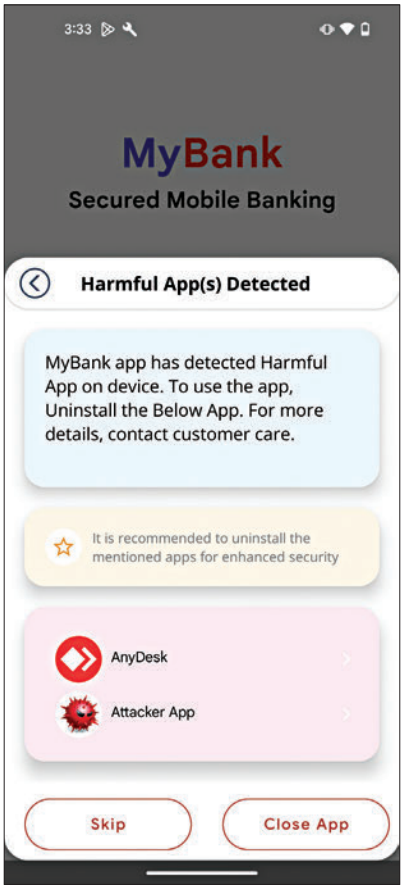
We are currently building this report and expect to publish some findings in approximately 45 days. In terms of overall value, I believe the contribution is almost equal. In terms of quantity, there may be fewer incidents in India and more in Bharat, but in terms of value, they are almost the same.

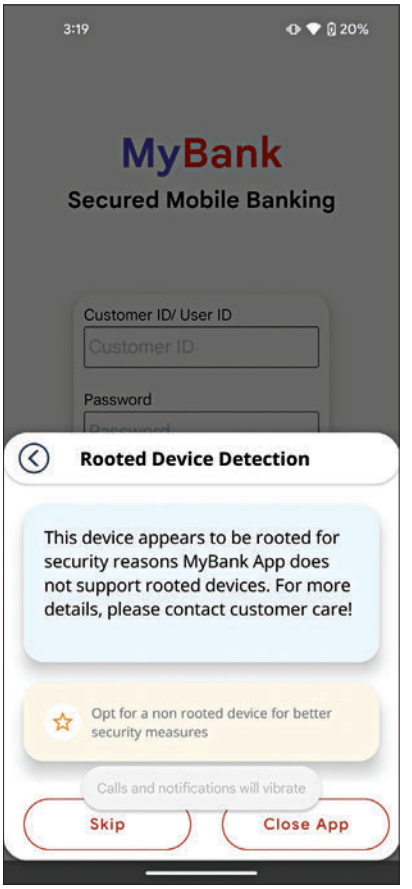
How can consumers instantly spot a scam, and what rules do you personally follow?

Manish: The basics are important. If you receive any call, email, SMS or WhatsApp message, whether solicited or unsolicited, be careful. If something asks you to download anything, do not click on it until you have established that it has come from a genuine source.

Do not reveal confidential information over phone calls. Fraudsters often pretend to be genuine, which can confuse people. If someone has clicked on a link, downloaded something or shared sensitive information, they should be particularly careful about their transaction systems if they believe they have been compromised. Immediately change passwords. If an APK has been downloaded, delete it. If banking information has been shared, passwords and PINs should be changed regularly – at least every 30–45 days for banking info.

If a fraud has occurred, report it through the Cybercrime Portal and call 1930. There are experts and organisations available to assist victims. Protectt.ai also has an expertise and consulting team that can help victims.





Organisations such as I4C, along with major fintech companies and banks, have support centres for cyber incidents where consumers can seek assistance.

The fundamental principle is not to get intimidated or fall for schemes offering unrealistic discounts, money or coupons. Be careful about clicking links and sharing information. When in doubt, the best thing to do is stop and consult an expert. Even if a call appears genuine, if you are suspicious, stop the interaction and verify it independently before proceeding.

How is Protectt.ai keeping smartphone users protected?

Manish: We work with corporations rather than directly with consumers, but our security is consumer-focused. We secure banking and UPI applications. Our security is human-centric. If we identify a threat on a device, we provide the user with the appropriate message or alert.

For example, if you are using a banking application where Protectt.ai is integrated and remote access is enabled on your device, our system can identify it, tell the user that remote access is enabled, and recommend not using the mobile banking application because someone may be viewing the screen.

We have thousands of such cases where consumers say they do not know what remote access is. This means their devices may already be accessible to someone else.

Potentially, the entire phone activity can be viewed or recorded. We have identified lakhs of such cases.

By providing the right message on the screen, we enable users to close remote access. We also help prevent screenshots of sensitive application pages from being captured.